FOR IMMEDIATE RELEASE
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2008 PEJ Raw Data Sets Now Available Online

Wednesday, July 1—The Pew Research Center's Project for Excellence in Journalism is pleased to release the 2008 News Coverage Index raw data set, Campaign Coverage Index raw data set, and toplines of additional content analysis reports. The data now are available to scholars for use in their research and can be downloaded on PEJ's website at http://www.journalism.org/by_the_numbers/datasets.

The News Coverage Index (NCI)—The NCI captures and analyzes some four dozen news outlets in real time to determine what is being covered and what is not in the U.S. news media. The NCI launched in January 2007 and has run continuously since. Weekly findings are released every Tuesday in a concise narrative that charts the top stories of the week, trajectory of the coverage, and differences among media sectors. In all, the 2008 NCI sample includes 48 outlets, every Monday through Sunday. The key variables include source, story date, big story, broad story topic, placement, geographic focus, story word count, and duration of broadcast story. The outlets studied come from print, network TV, cable, online, and radio. They include evening and morning network news, several hours of daytime and prime time cable news each day, newspapers from around the country, the top online news sites, and radio, including headlines, long form programs and talk.

The Campaign Coverage Index (CCI)—The CCI is based on a sub-set of PEJ's 2008 NCI—all the stories from Jan.1-Nov.3 2008 that were primarily about the 2008 presidential campaign. For these stories, PEJ added special coding to more closely examine the nature of the campaign narrative and the amount of coverage devoted to the candidate. During the year, these weekly reports were called the Campaign Coverage Index.

Additional reports—PEJ offers topline data for additional content-based reports. The focus of these opportunistic studies ranged from how the media covered the 2008 election to health care in the news and much more.

The 2008 NCI data set totals 69,942 stories: 7,350 newspaper stories, 6,539 online stories, 19,796 stories from network television, 21,892 stories on cable news, and 14,365 stories from radio programs. The 2008 CCI data set totals 18,836 stories, including 1,474 newspaper stories, 1,264 online stories, 3,977 stories from network TV, 9,202 from cable TV, and 2,919 from radio programs. Both data sets are offered in SPSS through the use of zip files and are accompanied by the coding scheme and other explanatory material. In addition, toplines from nine additional studies are included as PDF files. PEJ makes data sets of the Index available in a yearly basis. The 2007 data set was released in July of 2008. And data from 2009 will be available in July of 2010.

The News Coverage Index was designed by PEJ Director Tom Rosenstiel and Deputy Director Amy Mitchell and an advisory team of nine academic and commercial researchers, including Steve Lacy of the Michigan State University, Esther Thorson of the University of Missouri—Columbia and Dan Riffe of University of North Carolina—Chapel Hill. It required the creation of proprietary software and a new website. The index report is written by PEJ Associate Director Mark Jurkowitz. The coding team of fourteen professionals works 24 hours behind the news cycle. They work with content supervisor, Paul Hitlin, and supervising research methodologists, Hong Ji and Banu Akdenizli.

PEJ, which is non-partisan and non-political, is one of seven projects that make up the Pew Research Center in Washington, D.C., a "fact tank" funded by the Pew Charitable Trusts.